A Parks, Recreation & Trails Division for the East Carroll Parish Police Jury

Proposal for the Police Jury, December 2026. Get people outside and moving, and bring home federal and state money the parish is not receiving today.

7,195	35.7%	$0	0.9 km	55 km
residents (ACS 2023)	poverty rate; every tract is low-to-moderate income	recreation fund in the parish budget today	of built trail in the whole parish	dormant rail corridor + 48 km levee road

The ask (one resolution)

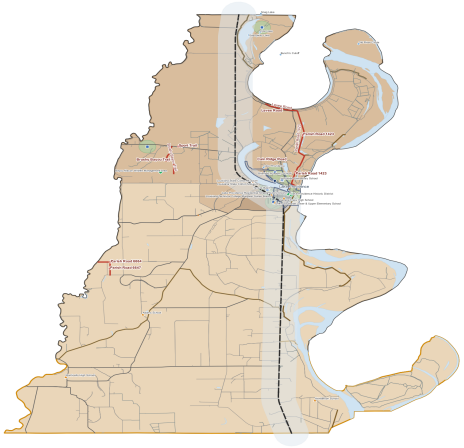
- Create a Parks, Recreation & Trails Division of the Police Jury and name a liaison juror.
- Authorize the President to sign grant applications; designate the Secretary-Treasurer as financial contact.
- No new taxes, no new entity, no new hires in year one. Road crews provide local match in kind.

Why East Carroll wins these grants

- USDA persistent-poverty county and DRA distressed parish: the highest funding tier in nearly every program.
- The parish already owns the raw material: Lake Providence frontage, ball fields, two boat ramps, the Mississippi levee road, a dormant rail line through every block group, and Bayou Macon WMA on its border.
- The Jury already has SAM.gov, a Single Audit history, and road equipment. Nothing waits on paperwork.

First projects

- **Lakeshore Loop**: 2 to 3 mile walking and biking path linking downtown, the Cotton Museum, ball fields, boat ramps, and the schools. Inside town limits; no railroad or Corps permission needed.
- **Levee bike route**: sign the levee crown road as a gravel bike route with a trailhead; a safe alternative to US 65 for the Mississippi River Trail (US Bicycle Route 45).
- **Rail-with-trail**: license from the railroad for 3 to 4 miles through Lake Providence; railbank if the line is ever abandoned.
- **Road safety**: a parish Local Road Safety Plan (LTAP writes it free) unlocks 100% federal money up to $500k per project.



Poverty by tract (tan), existing parks and schools, dormant rail line (dashed), levee (brown), half-mile park walksheds (green). Full map and data: github.com/wbp318/East-Carroll-Parks-and-Rec

Money on the table (local share shown; full list of 30 programs in the repo)

Program	Pays for	Local share	Typical award	Next date
LCDBG Public Facilities (LA OCD)	Rec center, community facilities, streets	0 to 10%	$500k to $1.5M	FY28 cycle, Aug 2027
Transportation Alternatives (LA DOTD)	Shared-use paths, sidewalks, Safe Routes	20%	$200k to $1.5M	Early 2027 call
Land & Water Conservation Fund (State Parks)	Fields, playgrounds, trailhead park	50%	$100k to $500k	April 1, 2027
Recreational Trails Program (State Parks)	Trails, trailheads, levee route signage	20%	$50k to $200k	July 1, 2027
USDA Community Facilities	Rec center, equipment, vehicles	25 to 75% grant	$50k to $2M	Rolling
Local Road Safety Program (DOTD/LTAP)	Signing, striping, shoulders, ped-bike safety	0%	up to $500k each	Quarterly
Louisiana Outdoors Forever (LDWF)	Match for the programs above	match source	$100k to $1M	Pre-app ~July 2027
DRA SEDAP (via North Delta LDD)	Public and transportation infrastructure	low (distressed)	$150k to $1M	~June 2027
Capital Outlay (Legislature)	Any public facility or road	state bonds	$250k to $2M	Request Nov 1
USGS 3DEP lidar	Parish-wide elevation data for design	~50% partner	varies	Nov 13 / Dec 4, 2026

Twelve months

Nov 2026	Resolution on agenda. Capital Outlay request. USGS lidar partner estimate (Nov 13).
Dec 2026	Division created. USGS lidar submission (Dec 4). First public meeting.
Jan to Mar 2027	Parish Road Program adopts trail segments. NPS RTCA application. TAP and AARP applications.
Apr to Jul 2027	LWCF (Apr 1). Master plan adopted. RTP (Jul 1). DRA SEDAP. Outdoors Forever pre-app.
2028	Lakeshore Loop phase 1 under construction. Levee route open. LCDBG FY28 application.

Sources: Census ACS 2023 5-year; Louisiana Legislative Auditor FY 2022 report (no recreation fund); program pages for LA OCD, DOTD, State Parks, LDWF, USDA RD, DRA, USGS. Dates from the latest published cycle; confirm with each agency. Prepared October 29, 2026.